

Esteban Torres

ENGINEERING MANAGER / HEAD OF ENGINEERING

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Engineering leader with 15+ years in tech and 7+ years managing engineering teams at Spotify, SoundCloud, and Zenjob. Track record across the full leadership ladder: individual high-performing teams, multi-EM organizations (3 EMs / 30+ engineers at Zenjob Supply), and platform-wide impact (current Head of Platform Engineering at Zenjob). Hands-on full-stack foundation in modern web (Node.js, React, TypeScript) and backend (Go, gRPC, NATS), with cloud-native infrastructure (Kubernetes, AWS, Terraform) and production AI experience (multi-provider LLM, embeddings, agent loops). Berlin-based.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Leadership

Engineering Management, Multi-Team & Multi-EM Organizations, Hiring & Career Development, Performance Calibration, Cross-Functional Partnership (Product, Design, Architecture), Distributed Teams Across Time Zones, Strategic Planning, Stakeholder Management

Modern Stack

Node.js, React, Next.js, TypeScript, Tailwind CSS, shadcn/ui, Go, Ruby, Swift, gRPC (with Protobuf/Buf), Pub/Sub (NATS JetStream), PostgreSQL, Microservices, Distributed Systems

Cloud & Platform

Kubernetes, AWS, Terraform, Docker, Infrastructure-as-Code, CI/CD Pipelines, Release Management, API Gateways, Observability (DataDog, Prometheus, Grafana), DORA Metrics, Incident Response & On-Call

AI-Native Development

GitHub Copilot, Cursor, Claude Code (organization-wide rollout at Zenjob across 60 engineers), Multi-Provider LLM Integration (Anthropic, OpenAI, Google Vertex AI), Embeddings & Semantic Search, Agent Loops with Tool Calling, Prompt Engineering

WORK EXPERIENCE

Zenjob -- Head of Platform Engineering -- October 2025 to present

Leading the Platform organization (5 direct including 1 EM, 8 indirect) supporting 60+ product engineers across the company. Owning infrastructure, observability, and developer tooling.

Treating the platform as an internal product: roadmap shaped by product-team friction, success measured in developer experience.

Standardized monitoring, alerting, and incident response across the org via Infrastructure-as-Code.

Drove company-wide rollout of AI-assisted development (Copilot, Cursor, Claude Code) across 60 engineers, including governance with Security and Legal.

Partnering with peer Heads of Engineering and the CTO on dependencies and strategy.

Zenjob -- Head of Engineering (Supply Vertical) -- January 2025 to October 2025

Led engineering for the Supply vertical (9 direct including 3 Engineering Managers, 30+ indirect), reporting directly to the CTO.

Bridged Product, Design, and cross-functional teams on a company-wide mobile platform migration (native iOS/Android to React Native) with evolving scope and tight timelines.

Hired and developed engineering leadership; conducted regular performance reviews and structured 1:1s.

Zenjob -- Engineering Manager (Platform & DevOps) -- May 2023 to January 2025

Led a team of 6 engineers building Kubernetes infrastructure, CI/CD pipelines, AWS, and platform services.

Delivered an API Gateway and APM service. Improved CI/CD pipeline stability by over 50%. Introduced DORA-aligned metrics across the organization.

Coached engineers from mid-level to senior through structured career development.

Spotify -- Engineering Manager (Remote) -- January 2022 to May 2023

Led a distributed team of 8 engineers (grew to 12, split into 2 specialized squads) across Sweden, the UK, Germany, Colorado, and New York, building Backstage, Spotify's open-source developer platform.

Post-split, managed half the team directly and 1 Engineering Manager who owned the other squad.

Defined the plugin marketplace architecture and contribution model. Shipped 3 monetized plugins, establishing a new revenue stream for Spotify.

Balanced product velocity with platform health (extensibility, contribution model, documentation).

SoundCloud -- Engineering Manager, Back-End Engineering Productivity -- October 2019 to January 2022

Led the BEEP and Core Clients teams (~8 ICs) owning JVMKit, a shared platform powering 200+ microservices serving 175M+ monthly users.

Drove reliability, performance, and extensibility for shared infrastructure used by every engineering team in the organization.

Coached engineers from mid-level to senior through structured feedback and career development.

SoundCloud -- Core Clients Engineer -- July 2017 to February 2020

Built developer tooling (Swift + Ruby) that reduced compile times by 7 minutes and integration time by 50%.

Improved playback performance by 15 seconds by extracting and refactoring Offline Sync into its own framework, increasing total listening time by 10%.

Built Prometheus-integrated observability tools for system monitoring at scale.

SoundCloud -- iOS Developer -- October 2016 to July 2017

Architected module extraction into micro features with clear API boundaries adopted across the iOS organization.

Earlier Career -- 2005 to 2016

Progressive engineering and leadership roles including Co-Founder at Craft Collective, Mobile Lead Engineer at Log(n) (built team of 4), iOS Developer at Brewbot (connected-hardware startup), and iOS Technical Lead at Samtec (built department of 6). Over a decade of hands-on engineering across mobile, backend, and tooling.

PRODUCTION SIDE PROJECTS

Quik

Production AI agent platform built in Go with gRPC services (Protobuf, Buf), NATS JetStream for Pub/Sub messaging, multi-tier LLM inference, embeddings pipeline with semantic search, and agent loops with schema-validated tool calling. Self-hosted SaaS architecture with full audit trails.

BlueTip

Production AI writing platform built with Node.js, Next.js, React, TypeScript, Tailwind CSS, shadcn/ui, and Stripe. Multi-provider LLM integration (Anthropic, OpenAI, Google Vertex AI) with streaming, guardrails, and tool-use.

OPEN SOURCE

Backstage (Spotify) -- Contributor to [Backstage](#), open-source developer platform.

OSS Community -- Active across [CocoaPods](#), [Moya](#) (Swift 2.0 migration), [ReSwift](#), [RxSwiftCommunity](#); contributions to Fastlane (s i gh team support), FBSnapshotTestCase (device-agnostic support).

EDUCATION

Licenciatura en Sistemas (~Licentiate Degree in Computer Science) 2003 to 2007

Universidad Latina de Costa Rica

iOS Development Bootcamp 2012

Big Nerd Ranch, Atlanta